



ATHENA
PLAYBOOK

TARGET PERSONA

ATHENA

Traditional undergrad, 18–22, first or second year, carrying 4–5 Canvas courses in a demanding or pre-professional track (pre-nursing, psych, bio, engineering) where GPA gates something concrete — grad school, a scholarship, program admission. Capable, not struggling. Works part-time, studies in fragmented pockets, phone as much as laptop. Steeped in free-tool culture and price-sensitive — leans on ChatGPT and Quizlet for free, won't pay for "general study help," only for something that clearly beats the free stack at a moment that matters.

Baseline stress is a low, persistent "am I missing something?" — spikes to panic 1–2 days before exams, when material's quietly piled up and they don't know where their gaps are. Friction tolerance drops as stress rises: calm, they'll tolerate setup; panicked, they abandon anything that doesn't just work.

Core problems: they can't see their own gaps (confuse "I've seen this" with "I know this"), have no durable study system so intentions decay into cramming, material's scattered across slides/notes/Canvas, and current tools only solve a slice — ChatGPT hands over answers they don't retain, Quizlet is generic and manual.

Athena's Canvas connection, gap-tracking, and coach-don't-tell approach map directly to these problems — with the caveat that the riskiest assumption is willingness to pay, which research doesn't support without a high-stakes hook or an institutional/free path.

ADJACENT TARGET PERSONA

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A college, university, or department — usually a success center, advising office, or Canvas admin — evaluating or paying for AI study tools on behalf of their students. They're already dealing with the problem whether they've addressed it or not: students are using ChatGPT and similar tools ungoverned, with no visibility into what's being shared or how it's shaping (or replacing) learning, and leadership is starting to ask what the institution's stance is.

They want to give students real support without three things: an unbounded per-student cost, student work or course IP exposed to a model that trains on it, or another disconnected tool that doesn't talk to Canvas.

Athena fits on all three. Sponsorship covers the student's cost directly, so there's no paywall between the student and the tool. The Canvas OAuth connection means Athena only ever sees what the student themselves can already see — no separate access grant, no new data exposure. And it doesn't train on or retain course material, so institutional IP stays contained. Net position: a safer, sanctioned alternative to the AI tools students are already using on their own — not an add-on, a replacement for the ungoverned version.

PERSONA COMMONALITIES

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Where the Institutional and Student personas overlap (the strength)

- **Same root problem.** Students are already on ungoverned AI; institutions are already anxious about that. One fix closes both gaps.
- **Same Canvas connection, two payoffs.** Frictionless for the student, secure for the institution — same OAuth, different sell.
- **Same "doesn't train on your material" fact, two payoffs.** Retention for the student, IP protection for the institution.
- **Coach-don't-tell.** Real understanding for the student, integrity story for the institution.
- **Gap-tracking** is early signal for both. Personal for the student, advising-relevant for the institution.

DAY IN THE LIFE

ATHENA

7:40 AM — Wakes up, checks Canvas from bed before anything else. Reflex. Small relief nothing's on fire, under a hum of I'm still missing something.

9:15 AM — Bio lecture moves fast. Flags two confusing slides with "??" to revisit later. Won't, until Thursday forces it.

12:30 PM — Studies between classes, but does the gradeable discussion post instead of reviewing. Busywork crowds out what matters.

8:30 PM — Finally "studies." Spends 20 min just assembling scattered slides, notes, and a generic Quizlet set. Re-reads what they already know; skips the "??" gaps.

10:15 PM — Stuck, pastes the question into ChatGPT. Gets a clean answer, borrows it, moves on — won't retain it.

11:40 PM — Dread is louder than this morning. Can't answer what don't I know and what do I do about it? Sets a vague "study tomorrow" intention that'll decay into cramming.

DIGITAL & BUYING BEHAVIOR

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Accounts Followed:

- Canvas (mandatory, checked reflexively)
- ChatGPT (free tier, homework/explanation crutch)
- Quizlet (free study sets, generic)
- TikTok / Instagram
- Notion or Google Docs/Keep (loose, self-built note systems)
- Discord (class group chats — where actual gap-checking happens socially: "does anyone understand slide 12")
- Spotify (study playlists, background noise during 8:30 PM sessions)

COMPETITIVE OPPORTUNITIES

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TBD

Look for intersections of opportunities that intersect product, brand message, and content; can be market adjacent brands; what are students looking at

what is everyone saying, selling, content look like, where opportunity

UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

ATHENA

Athena is an ai study coach that knows your courses and knows you — so it tells you what to study next and coaches you until you actually understand it.

It works from your real course content — lecture notes, assignments, and upcoming exams — not generic material, and tracks what you've mastered and where your gaps are, so it never wastes your time on what you already know. It guides you to the answer instead of handing it over, so you walk in ready because you understand the material, not just got past it. It's also the only study tutor that connects directly and securely to Canvas LMS, which makes it frictionless: it reads your materials, deadlines, and exams automatically — nothing to upload or set up.

POINT OF VIEW (POV)

ATHENA

Should feel relief — safe, supported, and not stressed (*"okay, here's where to start" not "you're out of time"*)

Should feel capable — a little smarter, a little more confident, each time (*"you've got this down" not "let's see if you got it"*)

Should feel in progress — clarity and growth, not judged (*"here's what's clicking" not "here's what you're missing"*)

Should never feel attacked — no shame, no condescension, no "Al slop" (*"let's try that again" not "that's not quite right"*)

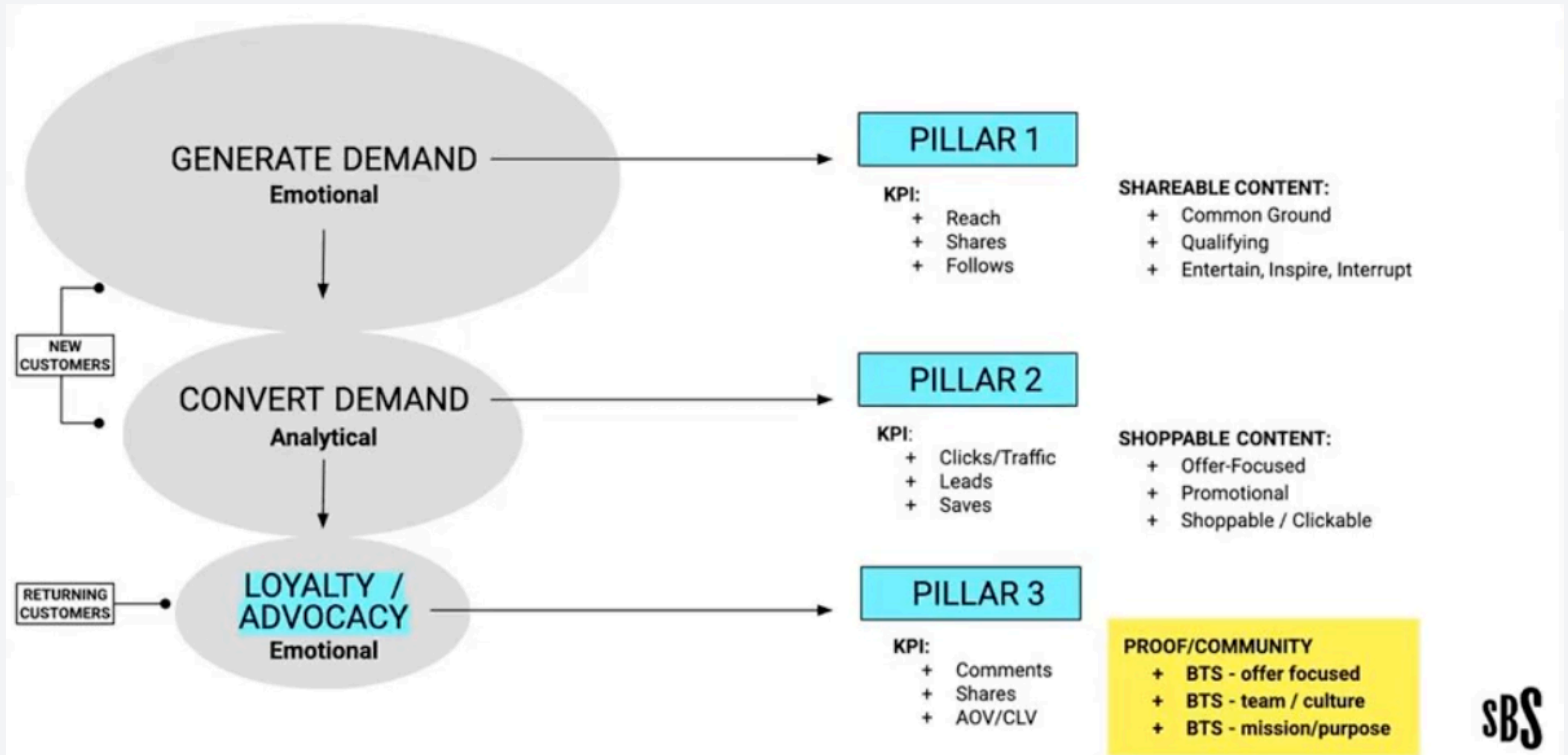
Should never feel stuck — never bored, nagged, or slowed down (*"quick answer" not "as I mentioned before..."*)

Language to avoid:

crush it · grind · *actually* · falling behind · as I mentioned · let's see if · that's not quite right · drill me · dominate · hustle · killing it ·

S3 SYSTEM OVERVIEW

ATHENA



S3 PILLARS OBJECTIVES

1

GENERATION DEMAND

Content Translation: Meets Athena's students at the **exact moment they feel stuck**, so the first impression **feels like relief, not a pitch**. Examples are: the late-night scramble before something's due, the slow-burn stress of exam prep, the mid-homework "I'm stuck right now" feeling, and the disorientation of learning how to study in a new environment. **It doesn't ask for anything or explain the product**; it just **needs a student to think, "that's literally me," and associate that feeling of being understood with Athena**. Tone is: friendly, calm, and supportive — never urgent or shaming.

Social KPI: Reach, shares, follows

2

CONVERSION DEMAND

Content Translation: Moves a student from "that's me" recognition into an actual trial signup. **A hook can lean into urgency when the platform calls for it**, but the **body of the content stays clear and confident rather than pushy**. The job is to make trying Athena feel like an easy, low-stakes yes: seven days free, then just \$5 a month, stated plainly rather than buried in vague benefit language. Here is where the **product gets explained — Athena value props drive content** (always on, guided support, focus on gaps/weak areas).

Social KPI: Clicks/traffic, leads, saves

3

LOYALTY/ADVOCACY

Content Translation: Content for students who are already using Athena and retention. **BTS content lives here: students quotes, case studies, success stories, and power-user tips on how students use Athena**. All of it reads as **lived experience, not brand claims**. The tone feels like a coach checking in, not a company retaining a subscriber: warm, personal, a little celebratory when it's earned. **Efficacy is a big lever here**. It needs students to feel seen for their progress, share their tips, and give them content they want to share with friends.

Social KPI: Comments, shares, AOV/CLV

PILLAR % ATHENA

PROPOSED FOR SUMMER/FALL 2026

PILLAR 1	PILLAR 2	PILLAR 3
30%	50%	20%
KPI: • Reach • Share • Follows	KPI: • Clicks/Traffic • Leads • Saves	KPI: • Comments • Shares • AOV/CLV

PILLAR 1

DEMAND GEN

1

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Social KPI: Reach, shares, follows

Where	How
Organic & Paid Social (Primary Channels: Facebook, Instagram, Reddit, Tiktok)	coming soon: these will detail and have examples of what to use + when to convert from organic to social
Organic Social	
Paid Social	
Email Marketing	

PILLAR 2 DEMAND CONVERSIONS

2

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Organic Social	
Paid Social	
Email Marketing	?

PILLAR 3

LOYALTY

3

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